Lesson 0.1: What the Claude Certified Associate certifies, and how the exam works

Claude Certified Associate – Foundations (CCAO-F) · Section 0: Start Here · Lesson 1 · 10:57

Description

Find out what the Claude Certified Associate – Foundations credential proves, who it is for, and how the exam is built and scored: 60 questions, 120 minutes, a pass mark of 720 on a 100–1,000 scale, and seven weighted domains. Every fact is shown in Anthropic's official exam guide and certification FAQ. Then you build a domain-weighted study map with Claude and check it against the source yourself.

Learning outcomes

By the end of this lesson you can:

1. Explain what the Claude Certified Associate proves and who it's for.
2. Describe how the exam is built and scored: 60 items, 120 minutes, 720 of 1,000, seven weighted domains.
3. Turn the official blueprint into a study map with Claude, and check it against the source.

Chapters

Time	Chapter
00:00	Preview and outcomes
00:33	Why it matters
02:32	How the exam works
04:10	Straight from the source
06:13	Hands-on: your study map
09:29	Exam angle
10:13	Recap and quick check

Key terms

- **Blueprint / domain:** the official outline of what the exam tests. It has 7 content domains, and each one has a weight.
- **Multiple-response item:** a question with more than one correct option. The question tells you how many to pick.
- **Scaled score:** your result on a 100–1,000 scale. Every exam version then has the same pass bar of 720.

- **Criterion-referenced:** measured against a fixed standard, not against other candidates.
- **Minimally qualified candidate (MQC):** the exam's target person. It's a hands-on professional who completes common Claude workflow tasks independently.

Exam facts in this lesson

- 60 items, multiple choice and multiple response. Each item says how many answers to select.
- 120 minutes, proctored, either online or at a test center. The exam is delivered by Pearson VUE.
- Scaled score from 100 to 1,000. The pass mark is 720. Scoring is criterion-referenced.
- Fee: 99 US dollars per attempt. Retake waits are 14, then 30, then 90 days, with up to 4 attempts in a rolling 12 months.
- The credential is valid for 12 months. On-time renewal is a free, non-proctored assessment.
- Domain weights:
    - Output Evaluation and Validation: 21%
    - Workflow Integration and Solution Design: 16%
    - Governance, Risk, and Responsible Use: 15%
    - Prompting and Task Execution: 14%
    - Product and Model Selection: 12%
    - Configuration and Knowledge Management: 12%
    - Troubleshooting and Optimization: 10%
- The weights are the approximate share of *scored* items. Per-domain question counts, such as "about 13" for Domain 2, are arithmetic estimates and are not stated in the guide.
- Eligibility, as of the date checked: certification is currently available to people at Claude Partner Network organizations who register with a company email.

Quick check

Before you move on, take this lesson's quick check. It's a few short questions and takes a couple of minutes. Every module ends with a module quiz, and the course ends with four full practice exams. All of them are original, written for this course against the official blueprint. They are never copies of the real exam.

Sources (all checked 2026-10-03)

- **Anthropic, *Claude Certified Associate – Foundations Exam Guide*.** Version 1.0, effective July 2026, exam code CCAO-F.
    - §1–4: purpose, audience, minimally qualified candidate, prerequisites
    - §5: exam details
    - §6: domains and weights
    - §8: sample question 1

    - §9: scoring
    - §11: retakes
    - §14: renewal
- **Anthropic Partner Academy, Certifications FAQ.** Covers eligibility, minimum age, language, permitted materials, scoring, retakes and renewal.
- **Anthropic Partner Academy, CCAO-F certification page.** Covers the exam fee.
- **Pearson VUE, Anthropic certification page:** https://www.pearsonvue.com/us/en/anthropic.html. Covers exam delivery, scheduling and retakes. The page was marked "Last updated 2026-10-02".
- **Rick Dakan, Joseph Feller and Anthropic, *The AI Fluency Framework*:** https://www-cdn.anthropic.com/b383cf6baddbfc72fdf8b0ed533a518e2872d531.pdf. Covers the 4D framework (Delegation, Description, Discernment, Diligence) and is released under CC BY-NC-SA 4.0.

Exam details can change. Always confirm current details in the official guide before you book.